# Setup Guide

*Civic Operations · Team MANTIS · from nothing to a running app in about 30 minutes*

This guide is for anyone, including people who have never used a terminal. You install one free program, download the project, type five commands, and open the app in your browser. Nothing is sent anywhere: the app runs only on your computer.

## What you need

| Item | Why |
|---|---|
| A Windows 10 or 11, macOS or Linux computer with 8 GB of memory or more | The app uses about 1 GB while running, Docker needs some too |
| About 10 GB of free disk space | The app, its models and the city road map |
| An internet connection for the first setup | To download Docker and the parts of the app. After that it runs offline |
| Docker Desktop, free | It runs the whole app in two sealed boxes called containers, the same on every computer |

## Step 1: install Docker Desktop

1. Go to docker.com, choose **Products**, then **Docker Desktop**, and download it for your computer.
2. Run the installer and accept the defaults. On Windows, leave **Use WSL 2** ticked. Restart when asked.
3. Open Docker Desktop and wait until the bottom left corner says **Engine running**. Keep it open while you use the app.

## Step 2: get the project

Pick one of the two ways.

- **Download a ZIP (easiest).** Open https://github.com/DevelopingGod/IRS-PM-2026-08-17-AIS08FT-GRP-MANTIS-CivicOperations, click the green **Code** button, then **Download ZIP**. Unzip it, for example to your Documents folder.
- **With Git.** If you have Git installed, type: `git clone https://github.com/DevelopingGod/IRS-PM-2026-08-17-AIS08FT-GRP-MANTIS-CivicOperations.git`

## Step 3: open a terminal in the right folder

- **Windows.** Open the project folder, then the **SystemCode** folder inside it. Click the address bar at the top, type `powershell` and press Enter. A blue window opens in that folder.
- **macOS.** Open **Terminal**, type `cd` (with a space), drag the **SystemCode** folder into the window, and press Enter.

You are in the right place when typing `dir` (Windows) or `ls` (macOS) lists a file called `docker-compose.yml`.

## Step 4: start the app

Type each line and press Enter. Wait for each to finish before typing the next.

```
docker compose up --build -d
docker compose exec backend python -m app.backend.manage import-backlog --count 150
```

```
docker compose exec backend python -m app.backend.manage team-accounts > credentials.txt
```

1. The first line builds the app. **The first time takes 10 to 20 minutes.** Later starts take seconds.
2. The second line loads 150 real New York requests so the queue is not empty. It takes about a minute.
3. The third line creates sign in IDs and PINs for city staff, crews and the tech team, and saves them in a file called `credentials.txt` in the SystemCode folder. Open it with Notepad or TextEdit. Keep it private.

## Step 5: open it

Open **http://localhost:8080** in Chrome, Edge, Firefox or Safari. Residents register with any email on the home page. City staff, crews and the tech team use the footer link **City staff, crew and tech team sign in** with an ID and PIN from `credentials.txt`. The Usage Handbook explains each screen.

## Stopping, starting and starting fresh

| To | Type in the SystemCode folder |
|---|---|
| Stop the app (your data is kept) | `docker compose stop` |
| Start it again | `docker compose start`, or `docker compose up -d` |
| Empty the queue and load fresh requests | `docker compose exec backend python -m app.backend.manage reset --yes` then the import-backlog line from step 4 |
| Give someone a new PIN | `docker compose exec backend python -m app.backend.manage reset-pin THEIR-ID` |
| Remove the app completely | `docker compose down -v` (this deletes its data) |

## If something goes wrong

| What you see | What it means | What to do |
|---|---|---|
| `docker` is not recognised, or command not found | Docker Desktop is not installed, or the terminal was opened before installing it | Install Docker Desktop, then close and reopen the terminal |
| Cannot connect to the Docker daemon, or error during connect | Docker Desktop is not running | Open Docker Desktop and wait for Engine running, then try again |
| no configuration file provided, or docker-compose.yml not found | The terminal is in the wrong folder | Go back to step 3 and open the terminal inside SystemCode |
| port is already allocated, or address already in use (8080) | Another program is using port 8080 | Close that program, or open docker-compose.yml, change "8080:80" to "8081:80" and use http://localhost:8081 |
| The build stops with a download or network error | The connection dropped while downloading | Run `docker compose up --build -d` again. It continues where it stopped |
| no space left on device | The disk is full | Free at least 10 GB. In Docker Desktop, Troubleshoot, Clean up data, removes old builds |
| WSL 2 installation is incomplete (Windows) | Windows needs its Linux layer for Docker | Follow the link in the message, install the update, restart, open Docker Desktop again |
| The page says Cannot reach the server | The backend is still starting, it loads its models first | Wait one or two minutes and reload. `docker compose ps` shows backend as healthy when ready |
| The page does not open at all | The containers are not running | Type `docker compose up -d`, wait a minute, reload |
| The queue is empty | No requests were loaded | Run the import-backlog line from step 4 |
| The ID and PIN do not match | A typing mistake, or an old credentials file | Check the ID letter by letter. Five wrong PINs lock an ID for 15 minutes. Use reset-pin for a new PIN |
| credentials.txt is empty or missing | The third line in step 4 was not run, or was run in another folder | Run it again inside SystemCode. It creates new accounts each time |
| Very slow on an older computer | Memory is short | Close other programs. In Docker Desktop, |

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| | | Settings, Resources, give it at least 4 GB |